PENGZHEN LI（李鹏振）

University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Department of Economics, Cherokee Mills F154
+1 (865) 266–5815 | pli26@vols.utk.edu | Homepage: pengzhenli.github.io/china/

EDUCATION

University of Tennessee, Knoxville expected May 2027
Ph.D. in Economics

Shandong University, Jinan 2018
M.A. in Finance — thesis published in *Technological Forecasting and Social Change* (2019); 1,000+ citations

Tongji University, Shanghai 2015
B.A. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Trade, Environmental and Energy Economics, and Applied Econometrics.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Four SSCI/SCI-indexed publications; 1,132 total citations, h-index 4 (Google Scholar, August 2026).

"Do green technology innovations contribute to carbon dioxide emission reduction? Empirical evidence from patent data." K. Du, **P. Li**, and Z. Yan. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 146 (2019), 297–303. **1,000+ citations (Google Scholar).**

"Spatial optimization of the sustainable aviation fuel supply chains from forest residues via fast pyrolysis/hydrotreatment considering feedstock ash content variability." **P. Li**, T. E. Yu, N. Labbé, N. Abdoulmoumine, M. Garcia-Perez, K. P. Hoyt, and B. C. English. *Biomass and Bioenergy*, 208 (2026), 108793.

"Assessing the impact of preprocessing and conversion technologies on the sustainable aviation fuel supply from forest residues in the Southeast USA." **P. Li**, T. E. Yu, C. Trejo-Pech, J. A. Larson, B. C. English, and D. N. Lanning. *Transportation Research Record*, 2678(9) (2024), 639–654.

"Beef price spread relationship with processing capacity utilization." C. Martinez, **P. Li**, C. N. Boyer, T. E. Yu, and J. G. Maples. *Journal of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association*, 2(1) (2023), 133–145.

WORKING PAPERS

Selling Down-Market: Market Access and the Quality of Chinese Exports [JMP] — evidence from Chinese customs records, 2000–2014.
Abstract: Trade liberalization can change export quality through cheaper inputs or through access to foreign buyers. I study the latter, exploiting the 2001 US grant of permanent normal trade relations to China, which eliminated the threat of tariff increases that varied across products. Comparing the same firm's US and non-US sales of a product before and after 2002, I find that quality fell about 5 percent more in highly exposed products than in barely exposed ones. The fall appears on impact, does not detectably reverse, and has no counterpart in the EU. Prices fell, but quantities rose less than the price decline alone predicts. I develop a model in which access lets firms sell down-market, to buyers who value quality less.

Trade Restrictiveness Indices with Discriminatory Tariffs with James Lake.

The Impact of Mayoral Endorsements on Presidential Election Outcomes: Insights from Brazil with Matt Van Essen and Luiz Lima. *2024 J. Fred and Wilma Holly Award (best second-year paper).*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Trade Restrictiveness Indices 2.0 with Massimiliano Cali, Aufa Doraset, James Lake and Laura Puzzello.

PRESENTATIONS

Midwest Economic Theory and International Trade Meetings, Virginia Tech Spring 2025
University of Tennessee, Economics Brown Bag Seminar Series Spring 2024, Fall 2024
University of Tennessee, Applied Micro Group Spring 2024, Fall 2024
Western Regional Science Association, Annual Meeting, Hawaii 2023
Western Agricultural Economics Association, Annual Meeting, Santa Fe, NM 2022
Southern Agricultural Economics Association, Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA 2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Tennessee 2021 – present
Graduate Research Assistant, Shandong University 2016 – 2018

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Tennessee

Instructor

ECON 351: Monetary Economics Spring 2025, Spring 2026
ECON 322: The Global Economy: Trade and Development Summer 2025
ECON 313: Intermediate Macroeconomics Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant

Ph.D. courses:
ECON 511: Microeconomic Theory Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025
ECON 512: Advanced Microeconomics Spring 2024
ECON 581: Mathematical Methods in Economics Summer 2024
Master's courses:
AREC 525: Agribusiness Operations Research Methods Spring 2022, Spring 2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Charles B. Garrison Award for Excellence in Teaching (best teaching), University of Tennessee 2026
Summer Graduate Assistantship, University of Tennessee 2025
J. Fred and Wilma Holly Award (best second-year paper), University of Tennessee 2024
J. Fred and Wilma Holly Fellowship, University of Tennessee 2023 – present
Graduate Assistantship, University of Tennessee 2021 – present
Academic Scholarship for Master's Students, Shandong University 2017
Freshman Scholarship, Shandong University 2016
Outstanding Rainbow Volunteer, Tongji University (tutoring pupils in Shanghai) 2013 – 2015
National Endeavor Scholarship, Tongji University 2014
Tongji Scholarship of Excellence, Third Prize, Tongji University 2014

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Stata, R, Python, SQL, GAMS, MATLAB, LaTeX, ArcGIS.
Methods: panel and causal econometrics (FE, IV, DiD, event study, SCM, GMM, panel threshold), time series (TVAR, VECM, mGARCH), mixed-integer and stochastic programming, DEA, cooperative games, discrete-choice game estimation, machine learning.
Credentials: CFA Level II.
Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent).

REFERENCES

James Lake (Chair)
Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee
Email: jlake7@utk.edu

Georg Schaur
Leigh Burch III Economics Professor and Haslam Family Faculty Fellow
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee
Email: gschaur@utk.edu

T. Edward Yu
Professor of Agricultural and Resource Economics
Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics
University of Tennessee
Email: tyu1@tennessee.edu